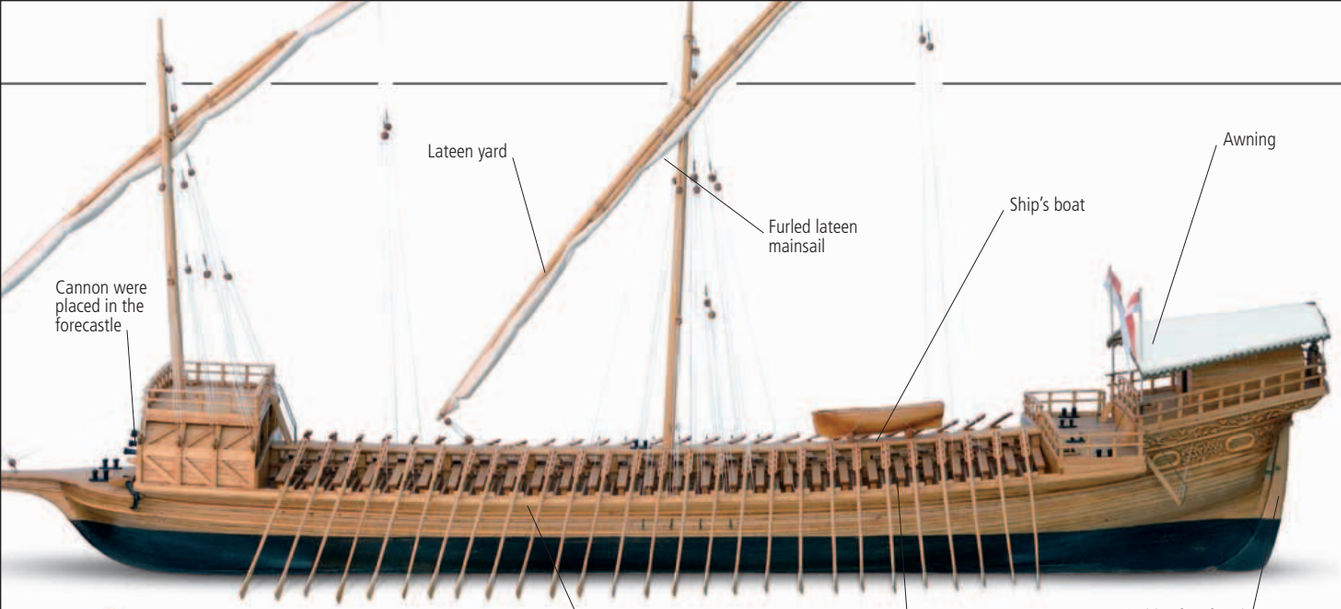
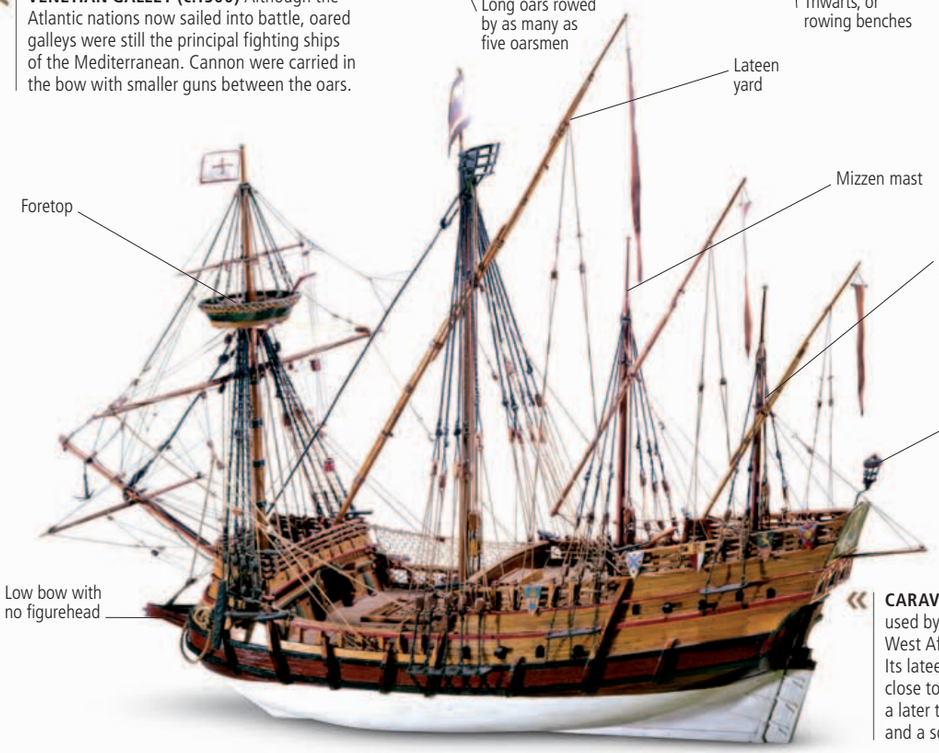


VENETIAN GALLEY (c.1500) Although the Atlantic nations now sailed into battle, oared galleys were still the principal fighting ships of the Mediterranean. Cannon were carried in the bow with smaller guns between the oars.



CARAVEL (c.1535) This kind of ship was used by the Portuguese to explore the West African coast in the 15th century. Its lateen sails were good for maneuvering close to shore. The example shown here is a later type with three lateen-rigged masts and a square-rigged foremast.

GLOSSARY

BIREME Galley with two banks of oars on each side.
BLINDAGE Protective screen for soldiers on deck of a sailing ship.
BLOCKSHIP Ship deliberately sunk to block river or harbor entrance.
BOATSWAIN Petty officer in charge of crew and sails, rigging, etc.
BOOM Barrier blocking river or harbor entrance.
BOW Fore-end of a ship.
BOWSPRIT Spar projecting from the bow, providing extra sail area.
BOW CHASER Cannon placed in the bow of a sailing ship for firing straight ahead.
BOMB-KETCH Small, strongly built sailing vessels on which a mortar is mounted.
BREECH-LOADER Gun in which shot or shell is loaded into the rear of the barrel (the breech) rather than the muzzle.
BRIG Small sailing ship with two square-rigged masts.
BRIGANTINE Ship with two masts, a fore-and-aft mainsail and a square-rigged foremast, originally used by pirates.
BROADSIDE Simultaneous firing of all the cannon on one side of a warship.
BULKHEAD Vertical partition below deck that separates one part of a ship from another.
CANISTER Container holding small iron or lead balls, fired from cannon as anti-personnel weapon.
CANNON Large artillery piece for firing heavy projectiles over a long distance. A naval cannon is usually referred to as a gun.
CAPITAL SHIP Warship of the first rank in size and armament, such as a battleship.
CARRACK Three- or four-masted sailing ship of 15th and 16th centuries.
CARAVEL Small, maneuverable ship developed in 15th century with lateen sails on two or three masts.
CARRONADE Short-barreled, short-range cannon developed by Carron Ironworks c.1770.
CHAFF Scraps of metal foil thrown out by planes or ships to confuse enemy's radar.
CHAIN SHOT Ammunition for cannon consisting of two half-balls chained together for attacking rigging, masts, etc.

